Upwork Portfolio Strategy & Project Plans

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Top 5 Recommended Plugins

Install these in Claude to get professional-grade portfolio output and engineering workflows.

Plugin	What It Does	Why You Need It
Portfolio Interview	Agentic portfolio creation with state-aware routing, eight skill packs, bilingual/RTL support, and approval-gated publishing	Automates the entire portfolio site build — structure, copy, QA — so you ship faster
Website Design	Picks a design direction from real websites, writes a DESIGN.md, builds responsive pages that don't look AI-generated	Your portfolio pieces need to look like real products, not templates
Skills For Real React/React Native Engineers	React best-practice skills straight from a working .claude directory	Enforces the patterns Upwork clients expect: hooks, component architecture, performance
Engineering	Standups, code review, architecture decisions, incident response, documentation	Shows team-lead-level thinking — not just coding, but engineering process
Figma to Code	Turns Figma frames into React/Vue/HTML using your design tokens and existing components	Proves you can take a designer's handoff and ship pixel-perfect, accessible code

Project 1: SaaS Dashboard Landing Page + Interactive Demo

Every SaaS startup on Upwork needs a marketing site with an interactive product preview. This project shows you can ship a complete, conversion-focused product — not just write code.

What to Build

- A sleek landing page for a fictional project management SaaS (think "Linear meets Notion")
- Hero section with animated product mockup
- Interactive pricing toggle (monthly/yearly with smooth transitions)
- A live embedded mini-dashboard demo (drag-and-drop kanban board, charts)
- Dark/light mode toggle, smooth scroll animations with Framer Motion
- Fully responsive, mobile-first

Tech Stack

Next.js 14 (App Router), TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Framer Motion, @dnd-kit (drag-and-drop), Recharts (charts), Vercel (deploy)

Steps in Claude Code

1. Scaffold with `npx create-next-app@latest saas-landing --typescript --tailwind --app`
2. Run the **Website Design** plugin to generate a `DESIGN.md` from real SaaS reference sites
3. Build the landing sections in order: Hero → Features grid → Interactive Demo → Pricing → CTA/Footer
4. Add Framer Motion for scroll-triggered entrance animations and micro-interactions
5. Build the mini kanban demo component using `@dnd-kit/core` and `@dnd-kit/sortable`
6. Add a metrics chart section with Recharts (line + bar charts with dummy data)
7. Implement dark/light mode with `next-themes`
8. Test responsiveness across breakpoints
9. Deploy to Vercel and grab the live URL for your Upwork portfolio

Why This Wins Clients

SaaS founders are the highest-volume buyers on Upwork for frontend work. A polished landing page with an interactive product demo proves you understand conversion design, animation, and component architecture — exactly what they need.

Project 2: Real Estate Property Listing App (Full-Stack)

Real estate is one of the highest-paying niches on Upwork. A polished property app with map integration, filters, and auth instantly qualifies you for $50–80/hr contracts.

What to Build

- Property listing grid with advanced filters (price range slider, bedrooms, area, property type)
- Interactive map view with Leaflet markers and popups showing property previews
- Property detail pages with image gallery lightbox
- Auth with NextAuth.js (Google + email/password)
- Supabase backend for listings data and user favorites
- Mobile-first responsive design with bottom navigation on small screens
- Server-side filtering and pagination using Next.js Server Components

Tech Stack

Next.js 14 (App Router + Server Components), TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Supabase (Postgres + Auth), Leaflet/React-Leaflet (maps), NextAuth.js, Swiper.js (image carousel), Vercel (deploy)

Steps in Claude Code

1. Scaffold with `npx create-next-app@latest property-app --typescript --tailwind --app`
2. Set up a Supabase project with a `properties` table and seed ~50 realistic listings (title, price, bedrooms, area, lat/lng, images)
3. Build the listing grid page with server-side filtering and pagination
4. Add filter controls: price range slider, bedroom count, property type dropdown
5. Integrate React-Leaflet map with property markers and click-to-preview popups
6. Build the property detail page with a Swiper.js image carousel and lightbox

7. Add NextAuth for sign-in (Google provider + credentials) and a favorites/saved list
8. Use the **React Skills** plugin to enforce clean component patterns and performance
9. Test responsiveness — the mobile layout should feel like a native app
10. Deploy to Vercel and grab the live URL

Why This Wins Clients

Real estate agencies and proptech startups pay premium rates. This project proves you can handle geospatial data, complex filtering, auth, and a polished multi-page app — the exact combination these clients search for.

Pro Tips for Upwork Presentation

The difference between a $30/hr dev and a $60/hr dev on Upwork is how they frame their work.

1. **Write each portfolio piece as a case study**, not just a link. 2–3 lines: the business problem, your approach, and the key tech decisions you made.
2. **Lead with outcomes** — "Built a conversion-optimized SaaS landing page with an interactive product demo that loads in under 1.5s" beats "Made a Next.js website."
3. **Show the stack prominently** — Upwork clients filter by technology. Name Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind, Supabase, Framer Motion explicitly.
4. **Deploy everything live** — a Vercel link a client can click is worth ten GitHub repos they won't open.
5. **Record a 30-second Loom walkthrough** of each project. Clients watch videos; they skim text.